

review Republic of Colour

Barren and abundant. Playground and battleground. Larger than Europe and yet 30 times less its population. All this and more in a two-hour documentary on Australia, its contradictions and colour, its sheep shearers and its surfers, in actor Russell Crowe's distinctive and raspy voice. That's not the only country on show in the seven-film *Discovery Atlas* which will premiere on the Discovery Channel on January 26. In *India Revealed*, narrated by forceful and articulate



DIVINE REVELATIONS: Exploring countries and continents

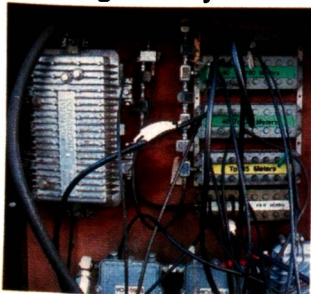
director Mira Nair, a 20-ft bamboo tower stood in for a crane while shooting in the middle of the Sundarbans mangrove swamp, while in *South Africa Revealed*, it took the crew three hours of filming in

the deepest mine in the world, where the temperature can touch a staggering 60 degrees Celsius, with 100 per cent humidity. Expect the series to illuminate and entertain.

recommendations Pop Art

BANGALORE Swiss actor, director and writer Peter Rinderknecht returns to India after two years with *Portofino-Ballade*, a musical play with puppets for children. A cuckoo pops out of the clock every hour every day, year after year, while his son refuses to take on the job that his father would like to pass on to him. A journey to the land of "what if?" "What if double basses were clocks? What if cuckoos were men?" *Portofino-Ballade* is a tale about

Talvin Singh's lens eye view



PICTURESQUE METAPHOR: Rinderknecht's *Portofino-Ballade*

families and freedom in our times. On January 18-19 at Ranga Shankara; on January 27 in Delhi at the India Habitat Centre.

MUMBAI We've known Talvin Singh for his mix of electronic dance and music styles, but not his romance with the camera. His exhibition of photography and sound installation, *Everyone is a Camera*, explores "the democratisation of camera and its image making process, the increasing use of video and mobile

cameras and sound recorders in our digital world." At Bombay Art Gallery till February 21.

BANGALORE Photographer David Trattles displays German cowboys, women boxers of Kolkata, tomato throwers of Bunol and the people of Novara and Balzan—ordinary people who do extraordinary things by looking at themselves. At Tasveer till January 23; later in Delhi and Kolkata.

by **Nirmala Ravindran**
and **Swati Mathur**

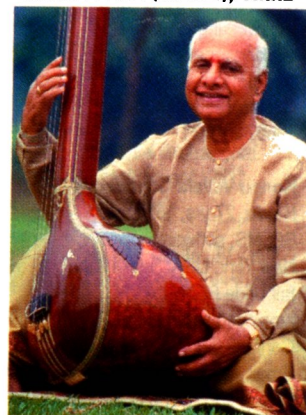
music review Time to Celebrate



Music Today
Rs 299

UTSAV
Music Today brings episodes that deal with themes like morning ragas and world music. Each theme is

explained by musicians such as Ustad Zakir Hussain (tabla), Pandit Shiv Kumar Sharma (santoor), Pandit Hariprasad Chaurasia (flute) and Pandit Jasraj (vocal). They point out the salient features of music before and after the performance. The format is conversational—the anchor and musician discuss the theme followed by a performance. The musicians featured in the series are Shobha Gurtu (thumri), Vikku



IN FULL FLOW: Vyas Vinayakram (Carnatic percussion), sitar maestro Shahid Parvez and C.R. Vyas. The Hori (Holi songs) theme features Hussain in conversation with Gurtu, where he throws light on how this style has evolved from the festival of colours. Another theme is Diwali where star guest Jasraj, in conversation with Hussain, explains the mythological significance of Diwali in music. The series will educate lay listeners and record legends for posterity.

by **S. Sahaya Ranjit**